Roblox state October 2026

Roblox trades viral spikes for retention

Roblox in October 2026 is a platform with **more players than a year ago but less money per player**. Q2 2026 DAU was **123M (+10% YoY)**, down from a **152M peak in Q3 2025**. Bookings grew only **+8%**, and management has guided **Q3 2026 bookings down 14–18% YoY** to $1.58–1.65B, with results due **October 29**. The company blames three of its own changes: **mandatory age checks for chat (worldwide since January 2026)**, a **Recommended For You algorithm that since June 15 judges games on 28-day retention instead of 7-day spikes**, and an engagement shift away from the high-spending 2025 viral hits (Grow a Garden, Steal a Brainrot) toward lower-monetizing games. The current #1 game, **Steal An Egg**, is a pet-collecting base-raiding game launched July 25 that peaked near **14M CCU** in late September and had fallen about 90% by mid-October. That pace, peak within 8 weeks and roughly 90% gone a month later, is now normal. For creators, the money is extremely concentrated: about **$1.7B was paid through DevEx in the year to June 2026**, but the **median DevEx participant earned about $1,500**. Rules are tightening on every side: all-ages publishing is gated behind verification and a "highly engaged players" test, ads to minors are restricted, and odds disclosure is mandatory for paid random items. Meanwhile AI agents inside Studio make routine scripting cheaper. For a new Nigerian freelancer at $18/hr with zero Upwork jobs, the opening is narrow but real. Clients need shops, game passes, DataStore saving and policy-compliant monetization built correctly, and they are wary of AI-generated or untrustworthy work. The freelancer should sell finished, verifiable systems at small fixed prices, keep everything on Upwork escrow in USD, and avoid Robux pay and Discord "job offers".

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Steal An Egg rules a chart that turns over in weeks

The breakout game of the second half of 2026 is **Steal An Egg**, created **July 25, 2026**, which Rolimons credits with more than **9.14B plays** (Rolimons). An Aream & Co. Q3 report cited by TIKR

puts it at about **6B visits and a 14.2M peak CCU** in Q3 (TIKR). Trackers place the peak during a September 19–26 crossover event: RoWatcher shows an all-time high of 14.3M and LiveCounts 13,790,561 on September 26 (RoWatcher, LiveCounts). In September it led every board checked. Max Power Gaming's monthly average was **1,447,549 CCU, up 167% from August** (Max Power Gaming), and a September 30 snapshot had it at roughly **5× the #2 game, Brookhaven RP** (StudioKrew). By mid-October it was still #1 but at about **1–1.6M CCU** (clip.dor.gg, RoVitals). Its developer is unconfirmed. Misfits Gaming posted that the game is part of its portfolio, and one undated report says it was briefly pulled after hitting #1; neither claim is verified (Misfits Gaming on X, EGamers.io).

Below it sit evergreen games. StudioKrew's September top six was Steal An Egg, Brookhaven RP, Blox Fruits, the new entrant **Ride A Pet**, Murder Mystery 2 and RIVALS (StudioKrew). MM2 fell 61% from its August peak (Max Power Gaming). **99 Nights in the Forest**, which peaked at 14.15M in October 2025, still ranks around #6 at roughly 130–390K CCU (Rolimons, RoCodes). The trackers do not fully agree: one LiveCounts "October 2026" chart showed MM2 on top at 1.12M, probably a timing artifact (LiveCounts charts). Session length differs sharply by genre. Meme and viral games average **8–12 minute sessions**, against **30–60+ minutes** for social RPG and tycoon games (RoWatcher), which matters now that discovery rewards retention.

The turnover is brutal and measurable. **Steal a Brainrot** peaked at about **25.8M CCU on October 11, 2025** and was reported at roughly 90–205K in early October 2026, a drop of more than 99% (Wikipedia, Lootbar). **Grow a Garden** peaked at **22.3M on August 23, 2025** (Wikipedia), and part of its sequel's later decline came from Roblox purging bot accounts, so some "player loss" was never real players (MMOexp). RoWatcher's longer view finds that about **80% of games that peaked in the top 50 during 2024 were not in the top 200 by early 2026**, and treats the first **90 days after a viral peak** as the window that decides survival (RoWatcher); this is single-outlet analysis with unverified methods.

Inference: viral hits reach peak in about 4–10 weeks, lose 80–90% within one to three months, and if they survive settle near 1% of peak a year later. The "steal-X" base-raiding format has now topped the platform two years running, and the 2026 version adds pet collecting and egg hatching from the Adopt Me!/Pet Simulator lineage. Pet or creature collection plus base-raiding is therefore the strongest current formula, and Ride A Pet fits the same pet trend. That matches the Upwork demand sample, where "Steal a..." clones, tycoons, obbies, tower defense and creature collectors appear by name, while Grow a Garden and Dress to Impress no longer do (local Upwork pull, October 5–20, 2026). Steal An Egg's 14M peak is well below the 22–26M peaks of 2025, which suggests a lower viral ceiling under age checks and the new discovery rules, but that link is not proven.

Users still grow while bookings head 14–18% lower

Roblox's own filings tell a story of user growth decoupling from revenue. In **Q1 2026** revenue rose 39% to $1.4B, bookings rose 43% to $1.7B, DAU was **132M** and hours engaged were 31B (Q1 2026 shareholder letter). Even so, Roblox cut full-year bookings growth guidance from 22–26% to **8–12%**, citing age-check friction at sign-up, reduced viral sharing and slower new-user acquisition (Yahoo Finance). By the end of Q1, **51% of global DAU (65% in the US)** had completed age

verification (NBC News). In **Q2 2026** revenue rose 36% to about $1.5B, but bookings grew only **8% to about $1.6B**. DAU fell to **123M** and hours to **29B**, against a 40B peak in Q3 2025 (Q2 2026 share holder letter, Investing.com).

The CFO attributed the shortfall to "a greater-than-expected shift in engagement from high-monetizing 2025 viral games to new and evergreen experiences with lower hourly monetization", mainly among **under-13 users**, together with recommendation changes that favor long-term retention (Q2 transcript, Top Tech News). Baszucki said A/B tests showed a short-term monetization cost, with no timeline for when retention gains would offset it. Morningstar called it "a terrible second quarter across nearly every engagement and payment metric" (Top Tech News). The stock fell about 27% in a day (Alpha Spread), and full-year guidance was withdrawn. Q3 guidance is revenue **+4% to +10%** and bookings **$1.58–1.65B (−14% to −18% YoY)**, with a sequential DAU increase expected from seasonality and the discovery changes (Q2 shareholder let ter). The stock closed at $50.75 on October 19, **down about 37% year to date** (TIKR), and rose 6–7% in October on unofficial reports that Steal An Egg lifted Q3 engagement (Quiver Quant). Results come after market close on **October 29, 2026** (MarketBeat).

Growth is geographically lopsided. Secondary readings of the Q2 supplemental put **APAC at 41M DAU (+15%)**, **Rest of World 34M (+15%)**, Europe 26M (+1%) and US & Canada 22M (+6%). Europe was the only region with falling hours (−5%) (Investing.com). US & Canada still brought in **$846M of $1,469M** in Q2, and per-hour monetization is falling among young North Americans (PocketGam er.biz). Africa is not broken out; it sits inside "Rest of World".

Inference: Q3 will probably show a sequential DAU rebound from 123M, helped by Steal An Egg and back-to-school, but a YoY bookings decline is almost certain because Q3 2025 was a record viral quarter. The number to watch on October 29 is whether bookings land near the top of the range. For developers this means that **monetization per player-hour is the platform's problem in 2026**, and studios that hire will value people who can raise spend without breaking the new rules.

Creators share $1.7B, but the median takes home $1,500

DevEx, the program that converts earned Robux to cash, now has two rates. The standard rate is **$0.0038 per earned Robux** since September 5, 2025 (previously $0.0035), with a **30,000 earned Robux minimum** (PocketGamer.biz). Since **June 8, 2026**, a **$0.0054 rate** applies to eligible spend by **age-verified US adults (18+)** on game passes, subscriptions, select items and private servers. That raises the creator's effective share of qualifying spend from **26.6% to 37.8%** (Roblox docs, N etInfluencer). Some 2026 third-party guides still quote the old $0.0035 rate or a 100,000 Robux minimum; both are outdated (rolearn.dev). Robux paid to a freelancer by a client do not qualify for the 18+ rate; that rate applies only to qualifying player purchases (Roblox DevEx docs).

Payout totals are large but slowing. DevEx fees were **$423M in Q1 2026 (+50% YoY)** and **$363M in Q2 (+15%)** (Q1 letter, Q2 letter). At RDC 2026 Roblox said creators earned about **$1.7B in the 12 months to June 30, 2026**, with more than **$5B** paid since 2013 (IBTimes). The distribution is extreme. The **top 10 creators averaged $65.7M** each, nearly double the prior year's $33.9M; the top 100 averaged $10.8M and the top 1,000 $1.4M; and the **median of 42,000+ DevEx participants received about $1,500** (TweakTown, Dexerto). **Inference:** multiplying these out, the top 1,000 take

roughly 80% of DevEx dollars, leaving about $0.3B for the other ~41,000 participants. Q2's slowdown to +15% plus Q3's guided bookings drop suggest H2 2026 DevEx will come in flat or down despite the higher rates.

Creator Rewards (which replaced engagement-based Premium Payouts on July 24, 2025) pays **5 Robux per "Active Spender"** who spends at least 10 minutes in a game, if it is one of the first three experiences they launch that day. An Active Spender is someone who has spent at least $9.99 in the last 60 days and did not sign up or reactivate in that window. The second part, **Audience Expansion**, pays a **35% share on the first $100** spent by new or returning users in their first two months. Payouts are uncapped and held 60 days (DevForum announcement). No 2026 rate change was confirmed. **Inference:** the program pays for daily-return habits (streaks, daily rewards, events), not long sessions.

The 2026 monetization toolkit is broader than it was a year ago. **Managed Pricing** combines automated price testing with regional pricing set between 30% and 100% of the default price (Managed Pricing docs). Early regional-pricing tests lifted the share of spending users by **52% in the Philippines** and 26% in Brazil (Roblox newsroom). **Rewarded video ads** are open to all eligible creators, shown only to users 13+, and paid by EPM × impressions (DevForum). **Roblox Plus** ($4.99/month, launched April 30, 2026) pays creators **250 Robux per month for each of a new subscriber's first three paid months** when they subscribe through `PromptRobloxSubscriptionPurchase` in-game. It also pays up to 100 Robux per Plus subscriber who spends 60+ minutes in the creator's paid private servers (Roblox Plus docs). Plus incentives paid creators **more than 300M Robux** through August 17, 2026 (gameaccountvalue.com). Roblox's own guidance warns that "appointment mechanics and timers... are unpopular with Roblox users", and that "tourists" prefer immediate-value purchases (Roblox monetization docs). Third-party estimates put RIVALS at **$8–15M+ a month**, almost entirely from skins and battle passes (RoWatcher). A University of Sydney study of 15 top-earning games documented 14 "misleading, deceptive or unfair" monetization practices (USyd). Payouts are also changing: **Roblox Wallet** (with Airwallex) will pay eligible US 18+ independent creators every business day later in 2026, with international rollout in 2027 (GamesBeat).

Inference: a 2026 shop that follows the incentives looks like this:

- tiered passes (2x currency, VIP)
- consumable developer products (boosts, currency, skips)
- a cheap early starter pack for tourists
- a season pass for regular players
- paid private servers, which earn both the 18+ rate and the Plus bonus
- an in-game Plus prompt
- opt-in rewarded video for 13+ free players
- Managed Pricing switched on
- odds-disclosure UI on anything random

Every item on that list is buildable Luau and UI work.

Age gates, retention-weighted discovery and Studio agents rewrite the rules

Publishing to children now requires verification and proof of engagement

Mandatory **facial age estimation or ID checks for chat** went worldwide in January 2026 (Nasdaq/Roblox PR). Age-based accounts were announced in April, letting parents manage chat and block games up to age 15 (NBC News). The biggest structural change for developers is the **Kids/Select publishing gate**, rolling out since **May 19, 2026**. **Roblox Kids (ages 5–8)** shows only Minimal or Mild content. **Roblox Select (9–15)** adds Moderate (9+). Restricted content is 18+ only, and parents cannot unlock it.

To publish into those catalogs, a creator needs:

- an account in good standing
- age verification (facial estimation if under 18, government ID if 18+)
- 2FA
- a maturity questionnaire result of Minimal, Mild or Moderate
- either a **refundable 1,000 Robux per-game fee** or a Plus/Premium subscription at least two months old

The game must then pass an evaluation requiring **250 unique plays from "highly engaged players" in the last 60 days**. A highly engaged player is defined by account tenure, playtime, and a purchase anywhere on Roblox in the last 60 days. Expedited review costs a refundable **50,000 Robux** (Roblox creator-docs, Kids and Select, DevForum weekly recap). This corrects earlier notes in this project that said Plus was strictly required. The threshold has moved: DevForum material cites 500 earlier, but the current docs say 250 (DevForum AMA).

Content maturity labels (Minimal, Mild, Moderate, Restricted) are mandatory. Unrated games are limited to developers and collaborators until the questionnaire is done (content maturity docs). **Paid random items** must show the odds of every outcome as percentages summing to exactly 100%, before purchase. The rule covers luck boosts, pity systems and indirect cases, and a bare "(i)" icon does not count (paid random items docs). No 2026 relaxation was found.

Regulatory pressure explains the direction of travel. US state attorneys general have sued, including Louisiana (August 2025), Nebraska (March 2026) and Oklahoma (May 2026) (TechCrunch, Nebraska AG, Oklahoma AG). Trackers count at least 11 states with active suits, which is unverified (tech-insider.org). Australia's eSafety regulator obtained a court-enforceable undertaking in August 2026 to make kids' accounts private by default and block unknown adults from contacting them (The Star). Russia blocked Roblox in December 2025 and, according to Meduza, restored access around **June 10, 2026** after Roblox introduced age-group restrictions (Meduza). One research note called the lifting uncorroborated, but the dated Meduza and PocketGamer.biz reports are the stronger evidence. Several Gulf and MENA states have blocked or restricted Roblox, though their dates come only from aggregators (rblxdb).

Ad and monetization rules now hinge on player age

Roblox overhauled ad policy in March 2026 (Bloomberg). From **May 4, 2026**, the **Advertising Integrations Policy** covers non-Roblox ads that developers build into games. It bans ad personalization for under-18s, bans rewarded ad formats for under-13s (including avatar items or developer products given as rewards), keeps food, cosmetics, pharma and financial brands away from under-13s, and prohibits "free Robux"-style misrepresentation (Advertising Standards, DevForum). One secondary site reports that **cross-game sales of passes and developer products ended May 29, 2026**; that is unverified (rouniverse.com). **Inference:** combining the 18+ DevEx rate, the Restricted rating and the no-personalized-ads rule pushes monetization design toward adult audiences. Kid-focused games face both lower earnings per user and the Kids/Select gate, so maturity rating is now a business decision made at the design stage.

Discovery now rewards 28-day retention

Roblox's June 2026 "Optimizing Discovery" post expanded Recommended For You from a **7-day to a 28-day window**, split play-through into separate **play-through, session quality and spend** signals, and began sharing the full signal list and weights with creators (Roblox Newsroom). Secondary coverage describes D1, D2–7 and D8–28 retention inputs framed as an anti-clickbait measure (allthings.how). **Thumbnail personalization** tests several thumbnails across random user groups and favors the one with the best *qualified* play-through rate, for an average **+8.5% lift** (Thumbnails docs). GameAnalytics' 2026 benchmark puts median D1 retention at only about **10.3%** (GameAnalytics). **Inference:** clients should now care about D7 and D28 retention, session quality and conversion to spending, and clickbait thumbnails are penalized twice, in the thumbnail test and in the RFY ranking.

RDC 2026 pointed beyond the Roblox app

RDC 2026 (September 10–12, San Jose) announced **"Roblox Everywhere"**: games published as standalone apps on mobile, PC and console, with Roblox still running engine and servers. It starts with selected developers and storefronts, and no dates, storefront list or fees were given; the first creators get in-app-equivalent revenue share including the 18+ rate (Game Developer). It also announced **Chrome browser play by end of 2026**. **Build**, Roblox's text-to-game tool, is expanding from New Zealand to Serbia and Singapore; Roblox says about **9,000 games** have been published with it, and **71%** of their creators had never used Studio. RDC also previewed a **Scene Generator** for later in 2026 and **playtesting agents and AI NPCs** (allthings.how). The **Luau New Type Solver** reached general release, and its Studio beta toggle was removed on January 7, 2026 (DevForum). That replaces earlier notes in this project that found no general-release date.

Studio agents can now build, run and test games

Studio Assistant plus the **built-in Studio MCP server** now support a full agent loop. Agents can plan and write code, run Luau, start and stop playtests, simulate player input and take viewport screenshots (DevForum: built-in MCP + playtest automation, DevForum: screenshot tool). Assistant accepts external LLMs through bring-your-own-key (DevForum). A beta **Playtest Agent** subagent runs gameplay scenarios (DevForum), and creator-authored skills arrived in July (DevForum). The

August 19 multi-agent update lets external clients such as Claude Code target a specific Studio instance (DevForum).

Sentiment is mixed. A studio apologized after players objected to AI-touched assets (GosuGamers), indie developers are pulling public demos for fear of copycats (GamingHQ), and developers report AI moderation falsely terminating games (DevForum). **Inference:** AI squeezes the price of boilerplate scripting first, and the value moves to design, retention, compliance, polish and trust.

Hiring splits into Robux commissions and USD contracts

Roblox hiring runs through two markets that barely overlap. **Inside the community**, on the DevForum, Discord servers such as Hidden Developers, and Roblox's own **Talent Hub**, clients think in Robux and revenue share and expect a DevForum or Carrd portfolio (DevForum: How To Find Good Developers). Talent Hub posts can state pay in USD, Robux or percentage (DevForum bug report), but it has had **no built-in payment**, and developers complain that "USD" listings turn out to be Robux or percentage-only (DevForum: Payment in talent hub, DevForum: My stance on the Talent Hub). **Outside the community**, Upwork and Fiverr clients (YouTubers, brands, first-time founders) pay in USD and buy content as often as code. Salaried work sits on studio careers pages, such as Gamefam's "Programmer 3 – Luau" at **$65,000–$105,000** base, remote USA (Built In LA), and Voldex's Brookhaven lead role requiring 3–5+ years of Roblox experience and team leadership (startup.jobs).

The Upwork pull of 40 Roblox jobs (October 5–20, 2026) shows what off-platform clients actually buy:

Category	Share	Notes
Game dev / scripting	38%	DataStore saving most requested, then rebirth and game-pass shops, mobile+PC UI, RemoteEvent security
Animation for YouTube/TikTok shorts	22%	$20–50 per 30–60 s short, as low as $1/second
3D / UGC / avatar assets	15%	Bundles, dynamic heads, layered clothing
Video editing / promotion	10%	$5–10 per edited short
Other / testing	15%	Includes red flags: likes inflation, "recover stolen pets", item-delivery bots

None of the 40 was a UI-only job; UI appeared only inside development jobs. Twelve of 40 (30%) had fewer than five proposals, and 29 had verified payment. Fixed budgets clustered low (6 under $50, 6 at $50–199), with a few serious $1.6k–$4.5k jobs. Recurring client phrases included "works on mobile and PC", "don't break what already works", **"No AI-generated work"** and demands to "explain exactly what you personally handled" (local Upwork pull). Vendor hiring guides describe the work as "part engineering, part LiveOps and part economy design", stressing multiplayer architecture, cross-device performance and LiveOps readiness (Innovecs, Juego Studio). Rev-share team weightings put **programmers at 10% and UI designers at 4%** (DevForum). That supports pitching UI as a differentiator inside development work rather than as a standalone service.

Rates span two orders of magnitude:

Channel	Typical pay	Source
Fiverr Roblox GUI gigs	from $5–50; basic 2-screen package ~$25–35 incl. fees	Fiverr
Upwork posted Roblox jobs (Oct 2026)	most hourly ranges top out at $15–35/hr; agency pool $8–15/hr	local Upwork pull
Talent Hub freelancers (vendor estimate)	$15–40/hr mid-level, $50–120+/hr senior	Game-Ace
DevForum UI rate cards	15K–45K+ R$ per full UI package, or ~$75–150+ USD; one designer quotes $70/hr	DevForum Showy19, AstralDefined, DevForum UI sheet
Community UI rule of thumb	5K–8K R$ unscripted UI set; 10K–30K R$ scripted	DevForum
US studio salaries	$55k–$105k (Gamefam); ZipRecruiter models ~$92k–$110k	Built In, ZipRecruiter

Inference: at $0.0038 per Robux, a "5K R$ full UI" offer is worth about **$19** at DevEx, and 10K R$ about $38, before any 30% marketplace fee if paid through a game pass. Robux pay is therefore far worse than it looks, and experienced developers move to USD.

The main risk in 2026 is the developer's own security. Reports from 404 Media, Malwarebytes and Help Net Security describe attackers posing as employers who get developers to run malware disguised as a job offer. The attackers then take over the developer's Roblox group, move the game to a new group and take the Robux. One victim's game earned about 10,000 R$ a day, and recovery took more than 30 days (Malwarebytes, Help Net Security). A stolen-games case left about 2M Robux (about $8,500) ineligible for DevEx (DevForum). The older risks persist too. "Transfer first, pay later" deals end unpaid (DevForum), and informal revenue shares go unhonored (DevForum); Aftermath's Forsaken coverage notes such shares are often not legally binding (Aftermath). The community norm for larger jobs is **50–60% upfront** (DevForum).

A Lagos developer at $18/hr should sell compliant monetization systems

The opportunity matches the profile, but the proof does not exist yet

The profile is now titled "Roblox Developer | Luau Scripter | Game UI, Shops & Monetization" at $18/hr, with zero jobs. That positioning lines up with where the evidence points, provided it is sold as **development** and not as UI design. On October 20, before the retitle, the profile was missing from Upwork's top 300 for "Roblox developer" and ranked #145–148 for "Luau", "Roblox scripter" and the Roblox Studio skill filter. It ranked #28 in a Nigeria-only "Roblox" search. Upwork's recommender showed it only AI-automation jobs (local account audit, October 20, 2026). The new title fixes the keyword gap. Upwork says its matching "rel[ies] heavily on users' information" (Upwork Help), but earnings and reviews dominate ranking, so most early visibility will come from proposals.

The $18/hr rate sits inside the realistic band for new Roblox profiles, which is **$15–35/hr** going by posted jobs. It is above the $8–15/hr agency pools and well below the $50+/hr senior band. **Inference:** keep the rate but sell mostly **fixed-price deliverables**, since 20 of 40 jobs were fixed-price and buyers compare outputs, not hours. In the project's 50-profile study, the only Nigerian Roblox freelancers earning at scale had honest, focused profiles and real reviews. A Nigerian profile with polished copy but staged-looking $5 reviews earned almost nothing, and Upwork treats feedback-building as a suspendable violation (Upwork Help).

Six services that fit the evidence

Inference, ranked by demand and competition, drawing on the job sample and the 2026 rule changes:

1. **End-to-end game-pass/developer-product shop with DataStore saving and receipt handling.** This matches the most-requested systems.
2. **Paid-random-item odds-disclosure retrofit** for egg, crate and gacha games, which is exactly the Steal An Egg genre now being cloned. It is a small, verifiable fixed-price job.
3. **Monetization audit** covering price ladder, starter pack, 18+-rate-eligible products, private servers, the Plus prompt and Managed Pricing.
4. **"Repair and finish without breaking it"** work on existing games, a recurring brief in the sample.
5. **Mobile/PC UI scaling fixes.** In demand, but crowded.
6. **Kids/Select and maturity-questionnaire readiness**: a new and unsized market.

Price anchors from DevForum and Fiverr support a fixed-price ladder:

Package	Suggested price
Shop teardown	free–$15
Odds-disclosure retrofit	$40–80
Shop + pass system with DataStore	$120–250
Full monetization UI kit	$250–500
Rush or mobile-scaling add-on	+30–40%

All of these figures are inferences, not observed Upwork prices. The trend formula (pet collection, base-raiding, egg hatching) gives ready demo themes. **Inference:** a public demo place showing an egg-hatch shop with compliant odds UI, game passes and saving, on phone and PC, would serve as proof for most of these services at once.

Proof has to be personal and verifiable, because clients now ask applicants to explain "exactly what you personally handled" and to link published games. The DevForum norm is a gallery, a list of games with visit counts, and stated payment terms (DevForum portfolio example). AI should be framed carefully. Studio MCP and agent tools make faster delivery and automated playtest QA possible, but clients write "No AI-generated", so **"human-built and tested, AI-assisted"** is the safe pitch (inference).

Nigeria-specific community assets exist but are thin. Gamr Lab's **"Build Africa on Roblox"** cohort, with University of Lagos and UK-Nigeria Tech Hub involvement, is documented only in LinkedIn posts (LinkedIn). Pan-African game jams run on itch.io (itch.io panafrican2026). A petition asks for Lagos servers because of West African latency (Change.org). Roblox's **Jumpstart** program, which invests in creators building games that bring in 18+ players, has rolling applications (Roblox newsroom).

Getting paid from Nigeria: take USD through Upwork and batch withdrawals

Upwork offers three practical routes:

- **Direct to Local Bank (NGN)**, reported at **$0.99 per withdrawal**, with an undisclosed exchange-rate markup (Raenest).
- **Payoneer**, roughly $2 per withdrawal on the Upwork side plus up to ~3% conversion (Cleva comparison).
- **A USD virtual account** (Cleva, Grey, Raenest) via "Direct to U.S. Bank". Since **September 1, 2026**, that route reportedly costs **$2.99 per withdrawal** for freelancers with a non-US tax address. This comes from a competitor's blog and is not confirmed on Upwork's site (Cleva).

Grey charges about 0.8% (minimum $2) on ACH deposits plus ₦35 per naira withdrawal. Cleva advertises zero conversion fees apart from ₦50 stamp duty; that is self-reported (techeconomy.ng, Cleva). **Inference:** at small invoice sizes the fixed fees hurt, since $2.99 on a $50 withdrawal is 6%, so batch withdrawals to $300 or more and compare the real naira received across routes once money arrives.

Robux are the worst way to get paid from Nigeria. DevEx runs through **Tipalti**, whose payout methods "depend on where you live". Tipalti deducts a transaction fee, conversion adds a **1.9–3% FX fee**, and the payment method and tax form must be set up **within one week** of the first approved request (DevEx Portal docs). Non-US residents file a W-8BEN (rolearn.dev). **No source confirmed which Tipalti methods reach Nigeria.** Add the 30,000 Robux minimum (about $114) and Robux are a poor substitute for USD.

Upwork accounts carry their own risks. Nigerian users report ID verifications rejected for NIN slips, and some advise using an international passport whose name exactly matches the profile (Upwork Community). Sharing contact details or taking payment off-platform triggers suspensions (goLance). Connects cost $0.15 each (goLance). On tax, the **Nigeria Tax Act** took effect **January 1, 2026**. Residents must self-assess worldwide income, the first **₦800,000 is exempt**, returns are due by March 31, and failing to register carries a ₦50,000 penalty (TechCabal, Techpoint). No 2025–26 CBN circular specific to freelancer inflows was found.

Inference — operating rules:

- Keep every client on Upwork fixed-price milestones with funded escrow until the account has reviews.
- Work only in a client-owned place or a duplicate test place via Team Create.
- Never run executables, plugins or "game files" sent by prospective employers, and use a separate Roblox account with 2FA for client work.

- Decline percentage-only and "pay on 100% completion" offers.
- Keep payment records from the first job for tax filing.

Conclusion

Roblox in late 2026 has deliberately traded short-term revenue for safety and retention. That changes what clients pay for. Viral formats still appear: Steal An Egg proves a 14M-CCU breakout is possible under the new rules. But they now fade within weeks, and the algorithm, the Kids/Select gate, odds rules and age-based ad and DevEx rules all reward games that retain players and monetize transparently. A client's problem is no longer "build me a clone fast". It is "make my game earn more per player without breaking a policy or my existing code". AI agents in Studio make the first problem cheap and leave the second one valuable.

For a zero-review Nigerian freelancer, the open question is not positioning, which now fits the evidence, but proof and first contracts. The 30% of Upwork jobs with fewer than five proposals and the small, verifiable compliance and shop jobs are the realistic entry point. The pay strategy is USD on Upwork, not Robux. Q3 results on October 29 are the next signal. If bookings land at the top of guidance on the back of a pet/egg hit, expect a wave of pet-collecting and steal-style clone briefs, each needing exactly the shop, odds-disclosure and saving systems this profile advertises. The main uncertainties remain the unfetched primary pages, Tipalti's coverage of Nigeria, and whether the $2.99 Upwork fee and other single-source claims hold up on official pages.